

# Dhakshan **Fashion**

dhakshanfashions.com

## Hostinger Deployment Step-by-Step Guide

Complete guide to deploying the Laravel + React e-commerce platform on  
Hostinger shared hosting

Laravel 12

React 19 + Vite

MySQL

Hostinger hPanel

cPanel SSH

PWA

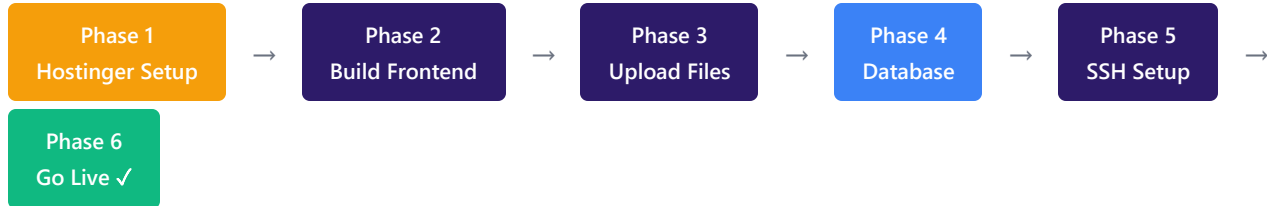
May 2026

Shared Hosting

Internal Reference

## Deployment Overview

This guide walks you through every step from local machine to live at **dhakshanfashions.com**



### How Files Are Organized on Hostinger

Hostinger gives you a home directory. **Only** `public_html/` is accessible from the browser. The Laravel app lives *outside* it for security.

```

# Hostinger Server Structure /home/ul23456789/ # Your Hostinger home folder
├── laravel/ # ← Laravel app (PRIVATE - not browser-accessible)
│   ├── app/
│   ├── bootstrap/
│   ├── config/
│   ├── database/
│   ├── routes/
│   ├── storage/
│   └── vendor/
├── app/public/ # uploaded images live here
├── .env # ← your production environment config
├── artisan
├── public_html/ # ← dhakshanfashions.com web root (PUBLIC)
│   ├── index.php # ← from deploy/index.php
│   ├── index.html # ← React SPA (from laravel/public/)
│   ├── assets/ # ← Vite-built JS & CSS
│   ├── .htaccess # ← from deploy/public_html.htaccess
│   ├── storage/ # ← SYMLINK → ../laravel/storage/app/public
│   ├── sw.js # service worker (PWA)
│   ├── manifest.webmanifest
│   └── favicon files...
  
```

#### ⚠️ Why this structure?

Putting Laravel files inside `public_html/` exposes your `.env` (database passwords, API keys) to the internet. Keeping Laravel one level up protects all sensitive files.

## PHASE 1

# Hostinger Account Setup

Configure PHP version, create database, and get SSH access



## Step 1 — Set PHP Version to 8.2

Laravel 12 requires PHP 8.2 or higher

1

### Log in to Hostinger hPanel

Go to **hpanel.hostinger.com** → log in with your account

2

### Open Hosting → Manage

Click on your hosting plan → click **Manage** button next to **dhakshanfashions.com**

3

### Find PHP Configuration

In hPanel, go to **Advanced** → **PHP Configuration** (or search "PHP" in the search bar)

4

### Select PHP 8.2 or 8.3

From the dropdown, choose **PHP 8.2** or **8.3**. Click Save.

✓ Also verify these PHP extensions are enabled: BCMath, Ctype, Fileinfo, JSON, Mbstring, OpenSSL, PDO, PDO\_MySQL, Tokenizer, XML, GD, ZIP



## Step 2 — Create MySQL Database

hPanel → Databases → MySQL Databases

1

### Go to Databases Section

In hPanel, find **Databases** → **MySQL Databases**

2

### Create a New Database

Enter a database name (e.g., **dhakshan**) → click Create. Hostinger will prefix it with your account username automatically.

📝 Write down the full database name shown (e.g., **u123456789\_dhakshan**)

3

### Create a Database User

In the same section, create a new user (e.g., **dhakshan\_user**) with a strong password.

 Write down: **username** (with prefix) and **password**

#### 4 Assign User to Database

In "Add User to Database" section, select your user and database → grant **All Privileges** → Save

 **Note these down — needed for .env file:**

```
DB_DATABASE = u123456789_dhakshan | DB_USERNAME = u123456789_dhakshan_user |  
DB_PASSWORD = (your password)
```



### Step 3 — Enable SSH Access

Required to run artisan commands and create storage symlink

#### 1 Go to Advanced → SSH Access

In hPanel, search for **SSH Access**. Toggle it ON.

#### 2 Note Your SSH Credentials

hPanel will show you:

- **Host:** (your server IP or hostname)
- **Port:** 22 (or 65002 for some plans)
- **Username:** your hPanel username (u123456789)
- **Password:** your hPanel password

#### 3 Test SSH Connection

Open **Command Prompt / Terminal** on your PC and test:

```
ssh u123456789@your-server-hostname # replace with your credentials
```

On Windows: Use PowerShell, Windows Terminal, or download PuTTY from [putty.org](https://putty.org)



### Step 4 — Create Email Account (for order notifications)

hPanel → Emails → Email Accounts

#### 1 Create noreply@dhakshanfashions.com

Go to **Emails** → **Email Accounts** → Create account **noreply@dhakshanfashions.com** with a password.

**2**

### Note SMTP Settings

Hostinger email SMTP settings (used in .env):

```
MAIL_HOST=smtp.hostinger.com MAIL_PORT=587  
MAIL_USERNAME=noreply@dhakshanfashions.com MAIL_PASSWORD=your-email-  
password
```

## PHASE 2

# Build the Frontend (on your PC)

Compile the React app and prepare all files for upload



## Build React App for Production

Run these commands on your local PC (not on Hostinger)

1

### Open Terminal in the frontend folder

Open PowerShell or CMD and navigate to your project:

```
cd C:\laragon\www\last-ecom\frontend
```

2

### Run Production Build

This compiles and minifies all React/JS/CSS into `laravel/public/`

```
npm run build
```

✓ Build output goes to **laravel/public/** — the assets/, index.html, sw.js, and icons are created there

3

### Verify Build Output

Check that these files now exist in `laravel/public/`:

```
C:\laragon\www\last-ecom\laravel\public\ ✓ index.html ✓ index.php ✓  
.htaccess ✓ assets\ # JS and CSS files with hash names ✓ sw.js ✓  
manifest.webmanifest ✓ storage\ # symlink (local only)
```



## Prepare the Production .env File

Fill in your Hostinger database and email credentials

1

### Open deploy/env.production

File location: `C:\laragon\www\last-ecom\deploy\env.production`

Open it in Notepad or VS Code.

2

**Fill in ALL the FILL fields**

```
# Generate APP_KEY — run this in your local terminal: php artisan  
key:generate --show # Copy the output (base64:xxxx...) into APP_KEY=  
APP_KEY=base64:your-generated-key-here DB_DATABASE=u123456789_dhakshan #  
from Hostinger step 2 DB_USERNAME=u123456789_dhakshan_user  
DB_PASSWORD=your_strong_db_password RAZORPAY_KEY=rzp_live_your_key # from  
razorpay.com dashboard RAZORPAY_SECRET=your_razorpay_secret  
MAIL_PASSWORD=your_email_password
```

⚠ Use LIVE Razorpay keys (rzp\_live...) for production, NOT test keys

3

**Save as .env (no extension)**

Save the file. This file will be uploaded to `~/laravel/.env` on Hostinger (not public\_html).

## PHASE 3

# Upload Files to Hostinger

Upload via File Manager or FTP — two separate upload operations

## 📦 Two Uploads Required:

### 1. Upload

#### Laravel app files

→ into `~/laravel/` (above `public_html`)

### 2. Upload

#### Public files

(React build + entry point) → into `~/public_html/`



## Upload 1 — Laravel App Files

Goes to `~/laravel/` — NOT inside `public_html`

**1**

### Go to Hostinger File Manager

hPanel → Files → File Manager. You'll see your home directory with `public_html/` folder.

**2**

### Create a "laravel" folder

In the home directory (NOT inside `public_html`), create a new folder named **laravel**

✦ Final path: `/home/u123456789/laravel/` — at the same level as `public_html`, not inside it

**3**

### Zip the Laravel project on your PC

On your PC, zip the entire `laravel/` folder EXCLUDING `laravel/public/`, `laravel/node_modules/` (if any).

```
# In PowerShell (excludes public/ folder): cd C:\laragon\www\last-ecom
Compress-Archive -Path laravel\* -DestinationPath laravel_deploy.zip -
CompressionLevel Optimal # Note: upload the zip, then delete
laravel/public from server
```

💡 Alternatively, use FTP software like FileZilla — it's easier for large uploads. See FTP section below.

**4**

### Upload and Extract in File Manager

In File Manager, open the `laravel/` folder you created. Upload the zip → right-click → Extract.

## 5 Upload the .env file

Upload your filled `deploy/env.production` to `~/laravel/` and rename it to `.env` (with the dot, no extension).

⚠ The .env file must be inside `laravel/` — NOT in `public_html`. It contains your database passwords.

### 📋 What to upload to `~/laravel/` — checklist:

- ☐ `app/` folder
- ☐ `bootstrap/` folder
- ☐ `config/` folder
- ☐ `database/` folder
- ☐ `resources/` folder
- ☐ `routes/` folder
- ☐ `storage/` folder (with empty `.gitignore` files preserved)
- ☐ `vendor/` folder (large — ~50MB, all Composer packages)
- ☐ `artisan` file
- ☐ `composer.json` and `composer.lock`
- ☐ `.env` (renamed from `deploy/env.production`)

✗ **Do NOT upload: `laravel/public/` — this goes to `public_html` instead**



## Upload 2 — Public Files (React Build)

Goes to `~/public_html/` — this is what browsers access

### 1 Open `public_html` in File Manager

Navigate to `public_html/` folder. You'll see the default Hostinger placeholder page — delete it.

### 2 Upload contents of `laravel/public/`

From your PC, upload everything inside `C:\laragon\www\last-ecom\laravel\public\` — but **replace** the two files below:

**⚠️ Replace these 2 files with the deploy/ versions:**

- Upload `deploy/index.php` → rename to `index.php` in `public_html` (replaces the Laravel one)
- Upload `deploy/public_html.htaccess` → rename to `.htaccess` in `public_html`

**📋 What should be in `~/public_html/` after upload:**

- ☐ `index.php` (from `deploy/index.php` — NOT the Laravel version)
- ☐ `index.html` (React SPA — from `laravel/public/index.html`)
- ☐ `.htaccess` (from `deploy/public_html.htaccess`)
- ☐ `assets/` folder (Vite-built JS + CSS)
- ☐ `sw.js` (PWA service worker)
- ☐ `manifest.webmanifest`
- ☐ `registerSW.js`
- ☐ favicon files (`pwa-64x64.png`, `apple-touch-icon-180x180.png`, etc.)

**Using FTP Instead (Recommended for large uploads)**

```
# FileZilla FTP Settings: Host: your-server-hostname # from hPanel → FTP
Accounts Username: your-ftp-username Password: your-ftp-password Port: 21 #
Create FTP account: hPanel → Files → FTP Accounts
```

## PHASE 4

# Database Setup

Import your local database or run fresh migrations



## Option A — Export Local DB and Import to Hostinger (Recommended)

Brings all your existing data, products, and admin account to production

1

### Export from Laragon (local database)

Open **HeidiSQL** (comes with Laragon) → connect to local MySQL → right-click **dhakshan\_fashion** database → **Export database as SQL**

```
# Or via command line: mysqldump -u root dhakshan_fashion >
dhakshan_fashion.sql
```

2

### Import to Hostinger via phpMyAdmin

In hPanel → Databases → **phpMyAdmin** → select your database **u123456789\_dhakshan** → click **Import** tab → choose the SQL file → click **Go**

✓ All tables, products, categories, admin accounts — everything from local will be live



## Option B — Fresh Migrations via SSH (Clean start)

Use if you want a fresh database with just the schema (no local data)

1

### Connect via SSH

```
ssh u123456789@your-server-hostname
```

2

## Navigate to Laravel folder and run migrations

```
cd ~/laravel php artisan migrate --force # Then create your admin user: php ar  
App\Models\User::create(['name'=>'Admin  
User', 'email'=>'admin@dhakshanfashions.com', 'password'=>bcrypt('your_admin_pass
```

## PHASE 5

# SSH Configuration & Final Setup

Run the setup script to configure permissions, symlink, and caches



## Run All Setup Commands via SSH

One-time setup after uploading files

### Connect to SSH first:

```
ssh u123456789@your-server-hostname
```

### Option A — Run the automated setup script

```
# Upload deploy/hostinger-setup.sh to ~/ then run: bash ~/hostinger-setup.sh
```

### Option B — Run commands one by one

#### 1. Set Storage Permissions

```
chmod -R 755 ~/laravel/storage chmod -R 755 ~/laravel/bootstrap/cache
```

#### 2. Create Storage Symlink (so uploaded images are accessible from browser)

```
# Remove old symlink if exists rm -f ~/public_html/storage # Create new  
symlink ln -s ~/laravel/storage/app/public ~/public_html/storage # Verify it  
worked ls -la ~/public_html/storage # Should show: storage ->  
/home/u123456789/laravel/storage/app/public
```

#### 3. Build Laravel Caches (makes the site faster)

```
cd ~/laravel php artisan config:cache # caches all config files php artisan  
route:cache # caches route definitions php artisan view:cache # caches blade  
views
```

#### 4. Verify Everything

```
# Check that .env is correct php artisan about # Test database connection php  
artisan db:show # Check storage symlink ls -la ~/public_html/ | grep storage
```



## Enable SSL (HTTPS) — Free on Hostinger

Required for online payments and PWA install

1

### Go to SSL in hPanel

hPanel → Security → **SSL Certificates** → find **dhakshanfashions.com**

2

### Install Free SSL (Let's Encrypt)

Click **Install** next to the free SSL option. Hostinger auto-renews it every 90 days.

3

### Force HTTPS Redirect

In hPanel → Security → SSL → enable "**Force HTTPS**" toggle. This redirects all http:// traffic to https://

⚠️ Razorpay payments **ONLY** work on HTTPS. Make sure SSL is active before testing payments.



## Point Domain to Hostinger

If dhakshanfashions.com is registered elsewhere (GoDaddy, Namecheap, etc.)

1

### Get Hostinger Nameservers

In hPanel → Domains → your domain → you'll see the nameservers:  
**ns1.dns-parking.com** and **ns2.dns-parking.com** (or Hostinger's nameservers)

2

### Update Nameservers at Registrar

Log in to wherever you bought **dhakshanfashions.com** → find DNS/Nameserver settings → replace with Hostinger's nameservers

⌚ DNS changes take 2–24 hours to propagate worldwide. The site may not be immediately accessible.

**3****Or — Add Domain in hPanel**

If domain is already registered at Hostinger, go to hPanel → Domains → it should already be pointing to your hosting.

## PHASE 6

# Go Live — Final Testing

Verify every part of the site is working correctly



## Pre-Launch Testing Checklist

Test each item after going live — check on mobile too

### Frontend & Navigation

- ☐ Homepage loads at <https://dhakshanfashions.com>
- ☐ Hero slider shows banner images
- ☐ Navigation menu shows categories
- ☐ Products page loads with images
- ☐ Product detail page opens correctly
- ☐ Search works and shows results
- ☐ Site works on mobile (responsive)

### Shopping Flow

- ☐ Add to cart works
- ☐ Cart page shows items
- ☐ Coupon code applies correctly
- ☐ Checkout address step works
- ☐ COD order can be placed
- ☐ Online payment (Razorpay) works
- ☐ Order success page shows

### Auth & Account

- ☐ Customer registration works
- ☐ Customer login works
- ☐ Admin login at /admin works
- ☐ Admin dashboard loads with data
- ☐ Profile page loads and saves

### Admin Functions

- ☐ New order appears in admin
- ☐ Upload product image — shows in frontend
- ☐ Upload banner — shows on homepage
- ☐ Order status can be updated
- ☐ Reports page loads with data



## Common Errors & Fixes

| PROBLEM                            | LIKELY CAUSE                                | FIX                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>500 Internal Server Error</b>   | Wrong .env, missing APP_KEY, or permissions | Check laravel/storage/logs/laravel.log for details. Verify APP_KEY is set. Run <code>chmod 755 storage/</code>                                 |
| <b>404 on page refresh</b>         | .htaccess not working                       | Make sure <code>deploy/public_html.htaccess</code> was uploaded as <b>.htaccess</b> . Check <code>mod_rewrite</code> is enabled in PHP config. |
| <b>API calls fail (CORS error)</b> | Wrong APP_URL in .env or SANCTUM config     | Set APP_URL=https://dhakshanfashions.com in .env. Run <code>php artisan config:cache</code> after changes.                                     |
| <b>Images not showing</b>          | Storage symlink missing                     | SSH: run <code>ln -s ~/laravel/storage/app/public ~/public_html/storage</code>                                                                 |
| <b>Database connection failed</b>  | Wrong DB credentials in .env                | Double-check DB_DATABASE, DB_USERNAME, DB_PASSWORD from Hostinger. DB_HOST must be <b>localhost</b>                                            |
| <b>White screen / blank page</b>   | PHP version mismatch or missing extension   | Set PHP to 8.2 in hPanel. Enable PDO_MySQL, Mbstring, OpenSSL extensions.                                                                      |
| <b>Razorpay payment fails</b>      | HTTP (not HTTPS) or wrong keys              | Enable SSL and use <code>rzp_live_</code> keys (not <code>rzp_test_</code> )                                                                   |
| <b>Admin login fails</b>           | Session cookie domain mismatch              | Set SESSION_DOMAIN=dhakshanfashions.com in .env. Clear config cache.                                                                           |

QUICK REFERENCE

# SSH Commands Cheat Sheet

Useful commands for managing your live site

## Everyday Maintenance Commands

```
# — Connect to server ————— ssh u123456789@your-server-
hostname # — Laravel commands (always run from ~/laravel/) — cd ~/laravel # Clear
ALL caches (run after any .env or config change) php artisan optimize:clear #
Rebuild caches (run after clearing) php artisan optimize # View error logs tail -50
~/laravel/storage/logs/laravel.log # Run database migrations (after code updates)
php artisan migrate --force # Put site in maintenance mode (during updates) php
artisan down php artisan up # Check PHP version on server php -v # Test database
connection php artisan db:show
```

## Deploying Updates (After Making Code Changes)

```
# — On your LOCAL PC ————— # 1. Rebuild the React
frontend cd C:\laragon\www\last-ecom\frontend npm run build # 2. Upload changed
files to Hostinger: # - Upload laravel/public/assets/ to public_html/assets/ # -
Upload laravel/public/index.html to public_html/index.html # - Upload changed
Laravel files (app/, routes/, config/) to ~/laravel/ # — On HOSTINGER SERVER (via
SSH) ————— cd ~/laravel php artisan migrate --force # if there are new
migrations php artisan optimize:clear # clear old caches php artisan optimize #
rebuild caches
```

## File Location Reference

| WHAT                    | LOCATION ON HOSTINGER SERVER           |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Laravel .env            | ~/laravel/.env                         |
| Laravel error logs      | ~/laravel/storage/logs/laravel.log     |
| Uploaded product images | ~/laravel/storage/app/public/products/ |
| Uploaded banner images  | ~/laravel/storage/app/public/banners/  |
| React SPA entry         | ~/public_html/index.html               |

**PHP entry point**`~/public_html/index.php`**Storage symlink**`~/public_html/storage → ~/laravel/storage/app/public`**Htaccess routing**`~/public_html/.htaccess`

## Required Hostinger Plan

**Single / Starter**

No SSH access. Cannot run artisan commands directly. Not recommended for this project.

**Premium / Business ✓**

SSH access included. Supports PHP 8.2. Multiple databases. Recommended minimum plan.

**Cloud Hosting ✓✓**

Better performance. Dedicated resources. Ideal for higher traffic stores.

## Dhakshan Fashion

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